# 1. Working Hours

Standard working hours are 09:00 to 18:00, Monday to Friday. Core hours, during which everyone must be reachable, are 10:00 to 16:00. Employees may start between 07:30 and 10:00 as long as they complete a full working day. The lunch break is 45 minutes and is unpaid. Overtime must be approved in advance by the line manager and is compensated at 1.5 times the hourly rate or as time off in lieu within 60 days.

# 2. Remote Work

After the probation period, employees may work remotely up to two days per week. Fully remote arrangements require approval from a vice president. Every remote employee receives a one-time home office stipend of 400 EUR and an internet reimbursement of 30 EUR per month. Remote staff must be reachable on Slack during core hours. Working from abroad is allowed for a maximum of 20 days per calendar year and requires a prior tax review by the finance team.

# 3. Annual Leave

Every full-time employee receives 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over and must be taken by March 31 of the following year; anything beyond that is forfeited. Leave of more than 3 consecutive days must be requested at least 2 weeks in advance through the HR portal. Public holidays are not counted against annual leave.

# 4. Sick Leave

Sick leave is paid in full for up to 15 days per calendar year. Employees must notify their manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence. A doctor's note is required after three consecutive days of illness. Absences longer than 4 weeks are handled through an individual case plan agreed with HR and the occupational health service.

# 5. Parental Leave

Birth mothers are entitled to 16 weeks of fully paid maternity leave. Fathers and partners receive 4 weeks of paid paternity leave, which must be taken within the first 6 months after the birth. Adoptive parents have the same entitlements. Returning parents may work part-time at 80 percent for up to 6 months while keeping full benefits.

# 6. Business Travel

All business trips are booked through the TravelDesk portal at least 14 days in advance. Economy class applies to flights shorter than 6 hours; business class is permitted for longer flights. The hotel cap is 160 EUR per night in major cities and 110 EUR elsewhere. Rental cars require approval from a director. Train travel in first class is not reimbursed.

# 7. Expenses

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days through the finance portal. Meals are reimbursed up to 40 EUR per day. A receipt is mandatory for every item above 15 EUR. Alcohol is not reimbursable. Claims above 500 EUR require the approval of the department head. Approved claims are paid with the next payroll run.

# 8. Learning and Development

Each employee has a training budget of 1,200 EUR per year; unused budget does not carry over. Conference attendance requires manager approval. Certification fees are paid upfront by the company and are subject to a 12-month retention clause. Employees also receive 5 paid learning days per year that can be used for courses, reading or internal workshops.

# 9. IT Security

Passwords must have at least 14 characters and multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all company systems. Laptops are fully encrypted. A lost or stolen device must be reported to the security team within 2 hours. Company data must never be stored in personal cloud accounts. Suspicious emails are reported with the phishing button. A VPN is required on public Wi-Fi.

# 10. Code of Conduct

Gifts from suppliers or clients worth more than 50 EUR must be declared to the compliance officer. Potential conflicts of interest are disclosed in writing. Harassment can be reported to HR or through the anonymous hotline, and retaliation against reporters is prohibited. Investigations begin within 5 working days of a report.

# 11. Performance Reviews

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and December, using a rating scale from 1 to 5. Feedback is collected from at least 3 colleagues. Salary adjustments take effect on April 1. Promotions are decided once per year. A performance improvement plan lasts 90 days and includes bi-weekly check-ins with the manager.

# 12. Leaving the Company

The notice period is 1 month during probation and 3 months afterwards. Company equipment must be returned within 5 working days. System access is revoked at 18:00 on the last working day. The final salary, including payout of unused leave, is paid with the next payroll run. An exit interview with HR is offered to every departing employee.